

Dynamical Neural Networks: System Theory, Learning, and Computational Complexity

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Outline

- Dynamic (recurrent) nets
- System theory
 - observability
 - identifiability
 - minimality
 - reachability
 - approximation
- Learning behavior from i/o data
- Universal model of analog computing

Recurrent or Dynamic Nets

Example (discrete time, two-dimensional):

$$x_1(t+1) = \sigma(2x_1(t) + x_2(t) - u_1(t) + u_2(t))$$

$$x_2(t+1) = \sigma(-x_2(t) + 3u_2(t))$$

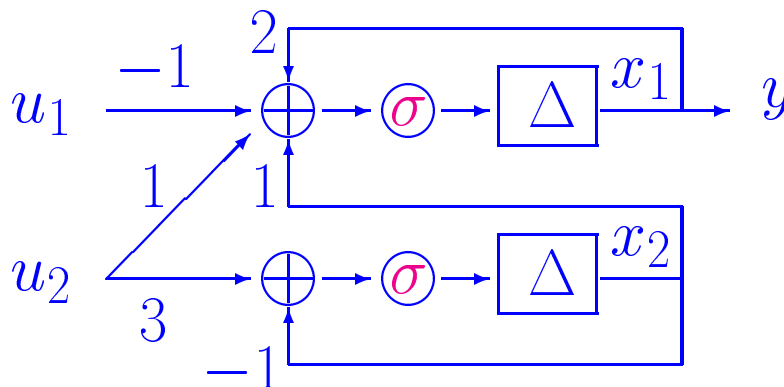
$$y(t) = x_1(t)$$

$\sigma : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ “activation” (saturation)

x_i internal state of i th processor (“neuron”)

$(u_1(t), u_2(t))$ external input

$y(t)$ measured response (output)



Or, differential equations $\frac{dx_i}{dt} = \sigma(\dots)$

General Model

Fix $\sigma : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ Lipschitz, odd (for simplicity of expo)

$$\vec{\sigma} (= \vec{\sigma}_n) : \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^n : \begin{pmatrix} x_1 \\ \vdots \\ x_n \end{pmatrix} \mapsto \begin{pmatrix} \sigma(x_1) \\ \vdots \\ \sigma(x_n) \end{pmatrix}$$

n -dimensional, m -input, p -output *recurrent net* :

$$\begin{aligned} \dot{x}(t) \text{ [or } x(t+1)] &= \vec{\sigma}(Ax(t) + Bu(t)) \\ y(t) &= Cx(t) \end{aligned}$$

specified by: $A \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times n}$, $B \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times m}$, $C \in \mathbb{R}^{p \times n}$
(weights, intensities, synaptic strengths)

$$\text{e.g.: } A = \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 0 & -1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad B = \begin{pmatrix} -1 & 1 \\ 0 & 3 \end{pmatrix}, \quad C = (1 \quad 0)$$

more generally, coords of $y(t)$ = outputs of p probes
each averages activation values of several “neurons”

write $\Sigma = (A, B, C, \sigma)$

Model Appears in Much Current Work

- associative memory and optimization (Hopfield)
- control of robotic manipulators (Jordan)
- speech recognition (Fallside, Kuhn)
- speaker identification (Anderson)
- formal language inference (Giles)
- sequence extrapolation for time series prediction (Farmer)
- signal processing (Bengio's book)
- adaptive control (Narendra)
- special purpose chips
- complicated dynamics
- but nice algebraic structure - generalize linear ($\sigma = \text{id}$)
- nice theory!

sometimes variations such as

$$\dot{x} = -Dx + \vec{\sigma}(Ax + Bu), \quad y = Cx,$$

— for many problems, may reduce study to $D = 0$

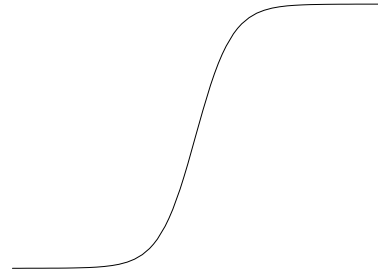
Possible Properties of σ

all will be OK for

$$\sigma(x) = \tanh(x) = \frac{e^x - e^{-x}}{e^x + e^{-x}}$$

i.e., up to translations,

“logistic” $1/(1 + e^{-x})$



more generally, various properties used:

σ satisfies IP (independence property) if
 translates/dilations $1, \sigma(a_1 s + b_1), \dots, \sigma(a_l s + b_l)$
 linearly independent, $\forall$ distinct (a_i, b_i) , $a_i > 0$

σ satisfies SP (spanning property) if
 translates/dilations $1, \sigma(a_1 s + b_1), \dots, \sigma(a_l s + b_l)$
 span C^0 , $\forall$ distinct (a_i, b_i) , $a_i > 0$ (closure; on compacts)

IP: OK $\tanh$, $\arctan$, $\dots$ suft extends to analytic on strip
 $S = \{| \operatorname{Im} z | \leq d\} \setminus \{z_0, \bar{z}_0\}$, (z_0 singularity, $\operatorname{Im} z_0 = d$)
 (Albertini-EDS'92) – also asympt suft conds

SP: OK $\forall$ loc Riemann integrable non-polynomial
 (Leshno/Pinkus'93)

(if not odd, ask all a_i)

Some Notations

$\xi \in \mathbb{R}^n$, $u : [0, T] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^m$ (measurable ess bd)

$x_{\xi, u}(\cdot)$ = soln of IVP :

$$\dot{x} = \vec{\sigma}(Ax + Bu), \quad x(0) = \xi$$

similarly for discrete time

Let $\mathcal{B} :=$ class of all $B \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times m}$ s.t.:

- $(\forall i) \text{ row}_i(B) \neq 0$
- $(\forall i \neq j) \text{ row}_i(B) \neq \pm \text{row}_j(B)$

($m = 1$: for vector b entries nonzero, $\neq$ magnitudes)
 complement of class is algebraic subset of $\mathbb{R}^{n \times m}$
 so set generic (full measure, open dense)

can infer activation values from i/o data $(u(\cdot), y(\cdot))$?

observability :

$$C x_{\xi,u} \equiv C x_{\zeta,u} \quad \forall u(\cdot) \quad \Rightarrow \quad \xi = \zeta$$

graph G : nodes $\{1, \dots, n\}$, edge $i \rightsquigarrow j$ if $a_{ij} \neq 0$

G_0 := nodes i s.t. i th column of C is $\neq 0$

“every variable influences the output”:

if every node reachable from G_0

Theorem. (Albertini+EDS'94) (d.t. & c.t., $B \in \mathcal{B}, \sigma \in \text{IP}$)

Observable iff e.v.i.o. and $\text{rank} \begin{pmatrix} A \\ C \end{pmatrix} = n$

necessity: obvious e.v.i.o. and

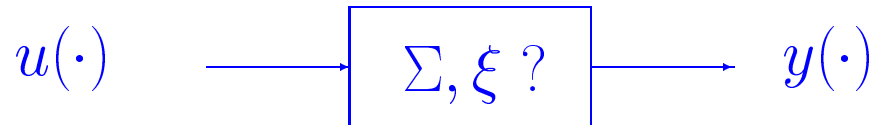
$C\xi = 0 \Rightarrow$ same instantaneous measurements as for $x(0)=0$

$A\xi = 0 \Rightarrow \vec{\sigma}(A\xi + Bu) = \vec{\sigma}(A0 + Bu)$ so same later too

sufficiency takes work: coord-invariant subspaces in $\ker C$

Form Determined by Function

realization problem (Springer L.N.'79):
suppose we have model of the I/O operator



are the weights/parameters uniquely determined?

Answer: yes! (up to state exchanges and/or sign flips)

denote $\lambda_{\Sigma, \xi} : u(\cdot) \mapsto y(\cdot) = Cx_{\xi, u}(\cdot)$ i/o map

i/o equivalent if: $m_1=m_2, p_1=p_2, \lambda_{\Sigma_1, \xi_1}=\lambda_{\Sigma_2, \xi_2}$

sign-permutation (s/p) equivalent: $n_1 = n_2$ and
 $\exists T = PQ, P = \text{permutation}, Q = \text{Diag}(\pm 1, \dots, \pm 1)$
 s.t. $TA_2 = A_1T, C_2 = C_1T, TB_2 = B_1, Tx_2 = x_1$

Theorem. (Albertini-EDS'92, ...)

($\sigma \in \text{IP}, \Sigma_i$'s observable, $B_i \in \mathcal{B}$, discr or cont time)

$$(\Sigma_1, \xi_1) \underset{\text{i/o}}{\sim} (\Sigma_2, \xi_2) \iff \text{s/p equivalent}$$

Model Minimality

assume same operator also realized by (Γ, ζ) :

$$\dot{z} = f(z, u), \quad z(0) = \zeta, \quad y = h(z)$$

states $\in Z =$ paracompact (real-)analytic conn manifold

$h : Z \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^p$ analytic

$f : Z \times \mathbb{R}^m \rightarrow TZ$ continuous, $\pi(f(z, u)) = z$

$f(z, u)$ analytic on z , f_z continuous on $Z \times \mathbb{R}^m$

and well-posed

“i/o equivalent” if outputs coincide for all possible inputs

Theorem. (for (Σ, ξ) , $\sigma = \tanh$, $B \in \mathcal{B}$, observable)

$$(\Gamma, \zeta) \underset{\text{i/o}}{\sim} (\Sigma, \xi) \Rightarrow \dim Z \geq \dim \Sigma$$

moreover: $\exists$ analytic submanifold Z_0 of Z

and analytic onto $\Pi : Z_0 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^n$ s.t.

$$h(q) = C\Pi(q) \quad \forall q \in Z_0$$

and $\forall u : [0, T] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^m, t \in [0, T],$

$$z_{\zeta, u}(t) \in Z_0, \quad \Pi(z_{\zeta, u}(t)) = x_{\xi, u}(t)$$

Possible State Configurations?

$\bigcup_{T \geq 0} \mathcal{L}_{\infty}^m[0, T]$ (concatenation semigroup) acts on $\mathbb{R}^n$
 via soln of IVP : $(\xi, u) \mapsto x_{\xi, u}(T)$

When transitive?

Theorem. (Sussmann+EDS'96) ($\sigma = \tanh$; cont time)

Transitive ($\forall A \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times n}$) **iff** $B \in \mathcal{B}$

uses $\lim_{s \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{\sigma(+\infty) - \sigma(as+b)}{\sigma(+\infty) - \sigma(s)} = 0 \quad \forall b, \forall a > 1$

$\leadsto T_{\xi} \mathbb{R}^n = \text{conv cone} \{ \vec{\sigma}(A\xi + Bu), u \in \mathbb{R}^m \}$

false for other IP; e.g. not transitive:

$$\dot{x}_1 = \arctan(x_1 + x_2 + x_3 + x_4 + 2u)$$

$$\dot{x}_2 = \arctan(x_1 + x_2 + x_3 + x_4 + 12u)$$

$$\dot{x}_3 = \arctan(-3u)$$

$$\dot{x}_4 = \arctan(-4u)$$

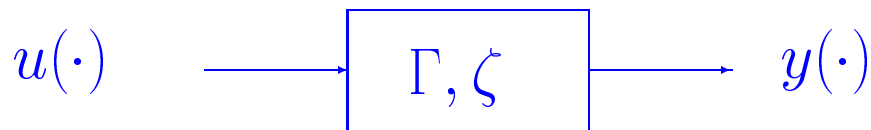
note: open problem for discrete time, on $(\text{range of } \sigma)^n$

Approximation

given i/o behavior $u(\cdot) \mapsto y(\cdot)$ realized by (Γ, ζ) :

$$\dot{z} = f(z, u), \quad z(0) = \zeta, \quad y = h(z)$$

(assume $z(t) \in \mathbb{R}^q$, well-posed)



Remark (EDS'92): using nets with $\sigma \in \text{SP}$
 can approximate arbitrarily close
 on equicontinuous sets of inputs, finite intervals

skipping (routine) statement of approx theo
 need $\dim n \rightarrow \infty$ for better approx, of course

based on density of “1HL nets” to approx RHS
 (Cybenko, Hornik-White-etc...)
 plus extra work to eliminate “hidden layers”

stability (“fading memory”) $\leadsto T = \infty$
 analog also valid in d.t.

Noisy Identification / PAC Learning

cf. Koiran-EDS NIPS'95 & EuroCOLT'97;
Dasgupta-EDS IEEE-IT'96; EDS'97



random inputs $u_1(\cdot), \dots, u_s(\cdot)$; ensuing $y_1(\cdot), \dots, y_s(\cdot)$
suppose $\Sigma_{\text{best}} = \text{net}(\Sigma, \xi)$ that best fits data

is Σ_{best} a good model?

- ‘random’ = ?
- ‘best fit’ = ?
- ‘good model’ = ?
- s (‘sample complexity’) = ?

Vapnik/Pollard/Haussler[/Valiant] technical framework
 $\approx$ uniform convergence empirical means ($\sim$ Glivenko-Cantelli)

how large s s.t. with high confidence (**P**robably)
know that Σ_{best} is accurate (**A**pproximately **C**orrect)?

Once Over, Lightly

Pick *loss* or (mismatch) *penalty* function $\mathcal{L}_{\Sigma, \xi}[u(\cdot), y(\cdot)]$

stationarity assumption:

training data $(u_i(\cdot), y_i(\cdot))$ as well as test pairs $(u(\cdot), y(\cdot))$
distributed according to same (unknown) prob measure P

$$\text{min total loss } \sum_{i=1}^s \mathcal{L}_{\Sigma, \xi}[u_i(\cdot), y_i(\cdot)] \rightsquigarrow \Sigma_{\text{best}}$$

good model := expected error on test pairs is ≈ 0

goal: show Prob (training data led to good model) ≈ 1

if set of possible inputs too rich, hopeless

discrete-time: finite length inputs

here continuous-time: match data to $O(T^k)$ on $[0, T]$

main result: for c.t. nets of dim = n , and $\sigma = \tanh$, enough

$$s = O(n^6 + n^3 \log k)$$

i.e. $O(\log k)$ for fixed dimension

Precise Formulation

Assume $\sigma = \tanh$, $\dim = n$ (and for simplicity, $m=p=1$)

consider output jet $Y_{\Sigma,\xi}(\mu) := (y(0), y'(0), \dots, y^{(k)}(0))$

corresp to $\mathcal{C}^{k-1}$ input with $\mu = (u(0), u'(0), \dots, u^{(k-1)}(0))$

$$\mathcal{L}_{\Sigma,\xi}[\mu, \eta] := \frac{\|Y_{\Sigma,\xi}(\mu) - \eta\|^2}{1 + \|Y_{\Sigma,\xi}(\mu) - \eta\|^2}$$

write $\zeta = (\mu, \eta) \in \mathcal{Z} := \mathbb{R}^{k+(k+1)}$

$\forall$ sample vector $Z_s = (\zeta_1, \dots, \zeta_s) \in \mathcal{Z}^s$: empirical loss

$$\widehat{\mathcal{L}}_{\Sigma,\xi}[Z_s] := \left(\frac{1}{s}\right) \sum_{i=1}^s \mathcal{L}_{\Sigma,\xi}[\zeta_i]$$

$\forall$ Borel probability measure P on $\mathcal{Z}$:

$$\mathbb{E}^P \mathcal{L}_{\Sigma,\xi} := \text{expectation of } \mathcal{L}_{\Sigma,\xi}[\cdot]$$

Sample Complexity Estimate

Theorem. For all small $\varepsilon, \delta > 0$,

$$s = \Omega \left((n^6 + n^3 \log k) \frac{\log(1/\varepsilon)}{\varepsilon^2} + \frac{\log(1/\delta)}{\varepsilon^2} \right)$$

$\Rightarrow$ with confidence $P^s(Z_s) > 1 - \delta$:

$$\mathbb{E}^P \mathcal{L}_{\Sigma, \xi} < \widehat{\mathcal{L}}_{\Sigma, \xi} [Z_s] + \varepsilon \quad \forall \Sigma, \xi \text{ (dim} = n) \quad \forall P$$

i.e.: $\inf \text{loss} = \lambda \Rightarrow$ with prob $> 1 - \delta$, expected error $< \lambda + \varepsilon$
 e.g.: $\lambda = 0$ if fit experimental data perfectly

note: even $\exists s < \infty$ not obvious

(cf. Macintyre-EDS STOC'93: based on Wilkie, o-minimality)

estimate by Warren/Khovanski (via Macintyre-Karpinski)
 and Pollard's pseudodimension (via Haussler)

related: $\min \widehat{\mathcal{L}}_{\Sigma, \xi} [Z_s]$? EDS, Adv Comp Math'96:

$\leadsto$ differential-topological study of critical points of $\widehat{\mathcal{L}}_{\Sigma, \xi} [Z_s]$

“computing” by continuous-space devices = ?

$\exists$ universal models, like Turing Machines for digital?

quantify resources (e.g. computation time); ask e.g.:

$P \subsetneq AP$ (“analog polynomial time”)? $NP \subseteq AP$?

“devices”:

$$x(t+1) = f(x(t), u(t)) \quad y(t) = h(x(t))$$

$$x(t) \in \mathbb{R}^n \quad u(t) \in \mathbb{R}^m \quad y(t) \in \mathbb{R}^p \quad x(0) = \xi$$

will assume f, h very regular

also: finite-dimensional, deterministic

(pde: many pathologies due to nonregularity

Pour-El, Richards, et al; wave eqn, etc)

also well-known difficulties if nonunique sols

–c.f. work of logicians on computing by ode’s

Possible Formulations of I/O

One possibility: input data $\sim$ initial state ξ
 assume guaranteed $x(t) \rightarrow$ equilibrium as $t \rightarrow \infty$
 Then let “answer” $:= x(+\infty)$
 done in e.g. Hopfield-type nets

Not totally clear how to formulate
 resource scaling with input “size”
 unless # dimensions scaled too

More natural idea, in comparison to digital:
 look at values of output variable $y(\cdot)$
 and ask how long they take to be produced
 as compared to the time it takes to read input

compare w/digital comp: decision problems
 (standard way to benchmark computing power)
 so use binary scalar inputs $u(t)$
 — need suitable notion of “binary” outputs $y(t)$

Input/Output Encodings

encode binary words $\alpha = \alpha_1 \dots \alpha_n \in \{-1, 1\}^+$ as inputs

$$u_\alpha : \mathbb{N} \rightarrow \mathbb{R} \quad (\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_n, 0, 0, 0, \dots)$$

$x_\alpha(\cdot) :=$ state traj with this u_α and $x(0) = \xi$

$y_\alpha(\cdot) :=$ output traj $h(x_\alpha(\cdot))$

Reading outputs: **don't** want to depend on

infinite precision “external observer”

e.g. “ans is NO if $y(t_0) = 0$ and YES otherwise”

well-behaved system if “unambiguous” output:

$$\exists T = T_\alpha \text{ s.t. } -\frac{1}{2} \leq y_\alpha(t) \leq \frac{1}{2} \quad \forall t < T, |y_\alpha(T)| > 1$$

interpret as “accept” if > 1 , “reject” if < -1

wb-system Γ **computes in polynomial time** if

$$T_\alpha \leq cn^k \quad \forall \alpha \in \{-1, 1\}^n$$

Let $L_\Gamma := \{\alpha \mid \Gamma \text{ accepts } \alpha\}$

Let AP = analog polynomial time
 = class of languages L_Σ for Σ computing in polytime,
 where $\Sigma : x^+ = \vec{\sigma}(Ax + Bu), y = Cx$,

$$\sigma = \begin{cases} -1 & \text{if } x < -1 \\ x & \text{if } -1 \leq x \leq 1 \\ 1 & \text{if } x > 1 \end{cases}$$



Theorem. (Siegelmann-EDS'92/94; *Science* 4/95)

$$\Gamma \text{ “reasonable”} \Rightarrow L_\Gamma \in AP$$

“reasonable” includes bounded & continuous
 piecewise combs of elementary funcs, real constants
 (precise def: can compute bits using sparse oracle)

not “reasonable”: discontinuities in transitions

– (Boolean input) Blum-Shub-Smale not included (open!)

Also: $P \subsetneq AP$; $NP \not\subset AP$ (unless $PH = \Sigma_2$)

(via $AP = P/poly = \text{Turing/advice} + \text{Karp-Lipton}$)

Summary

- introduced dynamic (recurrent) nets
- characterized internal state diagnosis (observability)
- form determined by function (identifiability)
- minimal if observable
- characterized transitivity of action (reachability)
- approximation (density)
- estimated complexity noisy identification / PAC Learning
- nets are universal model class for analog computing

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discrete-time, $\sigma(x) = e^{ix}$

closed-form algorithm for realization (noise-free case)

Assume $m = 1$ and generic conditions:

- $b_1, \dots, b_n$ nonzero
- $\sigma(b_1), \dots, \sigma(b_n)$ distinct
- $c_1, \dots, c_n$ nonzero
- observability: $\ker C \cap A^{-1}(\mathbb{Z}^n) = \{0\}$
- column space of

$$\begin{bmatrix} \sigma(b_1) - 1 & \cdots & \sigma(b_n) - 1 \\ \sigma(2b_1) - 1 & \cdots & \sigma(2b_n) - 1 \\ \vdots & & \vdots \\ \sigma((n+1)b_1) - 1 & \cdots & \sigma((n+1)b_n) - 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

has no nonzero lattice points ($\bigcap \mathbb{Z}^{n+1} = \{0\}$)

* **Procedure** $I/O \rightsquigarrow (A, B, C)$ *

Apply $2n$ different integer inputs of length 1:

$$\begin{aligned}
 & C\vec{\sigma}(Ax_0), \\
 & C\vec{\sigma}(Ax_0 + B), \\
 & \vdots \\
 & C\vec{\sigma}(Ax_0 + (2n - 1)B) \\
 = & \tilde{C}\tilde{A}^0\tilde{B}, \tilde{C}\tilde{A}\tilde{B}, \dots, \tilde{C}\tilde{A}^{2n-1}\tilde{B}
 \end{aligned}$$

where

$$\begin{aligned}
 \tilde{C} &= [C_1\sigma(A_1x_0), \dots, C_n\sigma(A_nx_0)] \\
 \tilde{A} &= \begin{bmatrix} \sigma(b_1) & & \\ & \ddots & \\ & & \sigma(b_n) \end{bmatrix}, \quad \tilde{B} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ \vdots \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}
 \end{aligned}$$

now linear realization to recover eigenvalues of $\tilde{A}$:

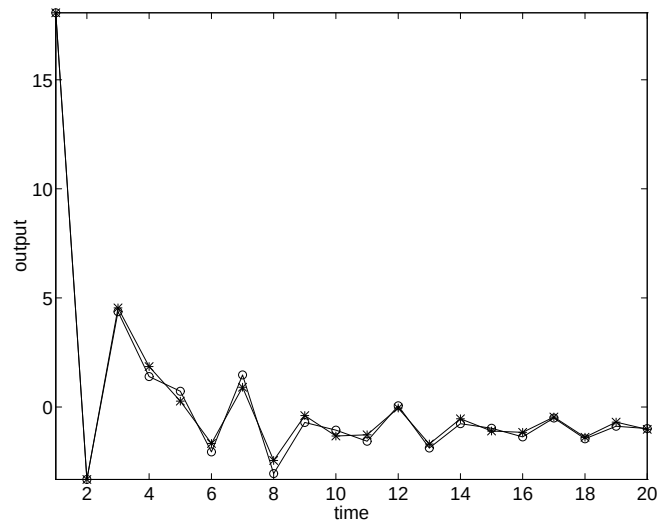
$$\sigma(b_1), \sigma(b_2), \dots, \sigma(b_n)$$

$\rightsquigarrow B$ (but we can't “invert” σ , so need a bit more)

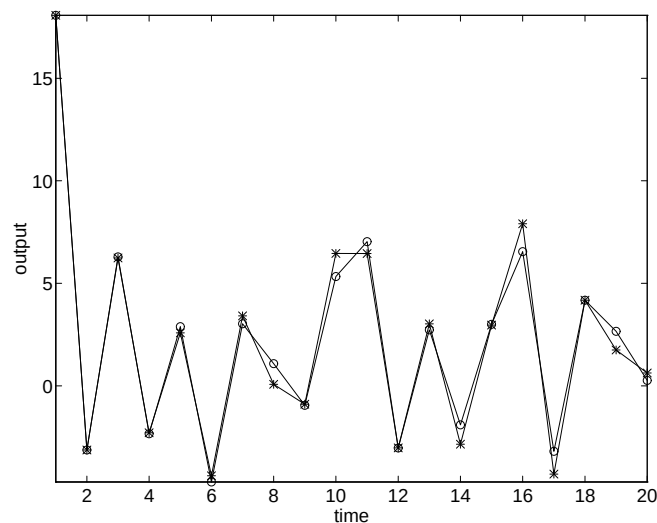
next find C and A ; also Cx_0 and $x(1)$ for any control

* MATLAB Implementation; check w/noise *

dim 4 example



input sequence of 20 ones; noise 10^{-3}
(true (o) and appx (*) outputs)



random input sequence, length 20; noise 10^{-3}